

Introduction to Biblical Greek

Session 2

English Grammar 101

Parts of speech:

Nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, prepositions, conjunctions.

English Grammar 101 (Nouns)

Nouns:

Parts of speech that name objects (person, place, thing, animal, or idea).

Adjectives:

Words that modify nouns (*beautiful* person, *cute* animal, *brilliant* idea).

Definite articles:

The word 'the' used to refer to a person or thing that is identified or specified.
(Almost all nouns in Greek are preceded by an article.)

John 3:16 (NRSV)

For ^NGod ^{DA}so loved ^Nthe world that he gave his ^{Adj.}only ^NSon,
so that ^{Adj.}everyone who believes in him may not perish
but may have ^{Adj.}eternal life.

John 3:16 (NRSV)

For	God	so	loved	the	world	that	He
	θεός			ὁ	κόσμος		
	<i>theos</i>			<i>ho</i>	<i>kosmos</i>		
gave	His	only	Son,	so that	everyone	who believes	
		μονογενής	υἱός		πᾶς		
		<i>monogenēs</i>	<i>huios</i>		<i>pas</i>		
in	Him	may not	perish	but	have	eternal	life.
						αἰώνιος	ζωή
						<i>aiōnios</i>	<i>zōē</i>

love

John 3:16

1) Forms change
2) Out of order

- ✓ 1) Masculine
- ✓ 2) Singular
- ✓ 3) Accusative

~~4) υἱός~~

~~5) direct object~~

the son is given

οὕτως γὰρ ἠγάπησεν ὁ θεὸς τὸν κόσμον

ὥστε τὸν υἱὸν τὸν μονογενῆ ἔδωκεν

ἵνα πᾶς ὁ πιστεύων εἰς αὐτὸν

μὴ ἀπόληται ἀλλ' ἔχῃ ζωὴν αἰώνιον

love the God
the world

student(s)

OX

ox(en)

Koine Greek Nouns

mostly feminine

They decline, a lot!

inflect

Three declension patterns
(First, second, and third declension)

grammatical
gender

In this course: second declension masculine nouns only!

mostly masculine

Koine Greek Nouns

They are weird!

1. They have *genders*! (But not the type you think)
2. They have *numbers* (singular / plural).
3. They have *cases*.

Koine Greek Nouns

Greek cases:

1. Nominative
2. Accusative
3. Dative
4. Genitive
5. *Vocative* (not assessed)

Koine Greek Cases

The Nominative case

- The *subject* of the sentence.
- The *subject* of a verb.
- Lexical form in the singular (uninflected)

E.g., *God* loved the world.

Koine Greek Cases

The Accusative case

- The *object* of the sentence.
- The *direct object* of a verb.

E.g., God loved the *world*.

Koine Greek Cases

The Dative case

- The *indirect object* of the sentence.
- Usually expressed in English with the words 'to', 'in', 'with' or 'for'.

N A D

E.g., He gave life *to us*.

He gave his life *for us*.

Koine Greek Cases

The Genitive case

- Used to denote *possession*.
- Usually expressed in English with the word 'of', or with a Saxon genitive (-'s).

E.g.: The Son ^G of God.
_G God's son.

Koine Greek Nouns

Why are Greek cases important?

“Thusly for he loved the God the world...”

Koine Greek Nouns

Greek sentences do not rely on word order.

Whether a noun is the subject, object, and so on depends on how they *decline* (their case endings).

E.g.: God.*subject* loved the world.*object*.

The world.*object* loved God.*subject*.

Loved God.*subject* the world.*object*.

Koine Greek Nouns

2nd declension, masculine.

Case endings:

	Singular	Plural
Nominative	-ος	-οι
Accusative	-ον	-ους
Dative	-ῳ	-οις
Genitive	-ου	-ων

9:30 pm.

stem θεο
θε-ος
υι-ος
κοσμο-ος

θεο
υιο
κοσμο

υιος
κοσμος
κοσμοι

Koine Greek Nouns

υἱος θεου

ἡγαγεν
ἡμᾶς

Case endings:

	Singular	Plural
Nominative	-ος	-οι
Accusative	-ον	-ους
Dative	-ῳ	-οις
Genitive	-ου	-ων

θεου
theou

Example:

God-ος loved the world-ον.

The world-ον loved God-ος.

Loved God-ος the world-ον.

Reconstruct this sentence:

We-ον, God-ου, Son-ος, loved.

Son of God loved us
God's son loved us

Koine Greek Nouns

Case endings

οὕτως γὰρ ἠγάπησεν ὁ θεὸς τὸν κόσμον

Koine Greek Nouns

The Definite Article

The word 'the' in English.

	Singular	Plural
Nominative	ὁ	οἱ
Accusative	τον	τους
Dative	τω	τοις
Genitive	του	των

✓ θεός theos

Koine Greek Nouns

λογος = word

κόσμος kosmos

✓ υἱός huios

The Definite Article

The definite article and the noun-ending *always agree*.

	Singular	Plural	Example using λόγος:	
Nominative	ὁ	οἱ	ὁ λόγος	οἱ κόσμοι
Accusative	τον	τους	τον λόγον	τους κόσμους
Dative	τῷ	τοῖς	τῷ λόγῳ	τοῖς κόσμοις
Genitive	του	των	του λόγου	των κόσμων

Koine Greek Nouns

Parsing a noun:

- *Gender*
- *Number*
- *Case*
- Lexical form
- Inflected meaning

Exam Format

Questions are enumerated, example:

1. I am learning Biblical Greek.
 - 1a. Which word is the subject of the sentence?
 - 1b. Which is the object of the sentence?
 - 1c. Which is the adjective in the sentence?

You will need:

1. Blank sheets of A4.
2. Stationery.